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Kaun Banega Crorepati

Adapted from Celador's chartbuster *Who Wants To Be A Millionaire?*, industry gossip says the Hong Kong-based Star TV's programming boss Steve Askew selected the format while its India programming head Sameer Nair zeroed in on Amitabh Bachchan as anchor...a masterstroke. Bachchan, then going through a lean patch, took a big risk going on TV, which was still looked down upon by film stars. But he worked hard, and watched various versions of the show. The production was entrusted to Siddharth Basu, India's best quizmaster. From the very first episode aired in 2000, *KBC* was a national rage.



C.I.D.

TV in India has a long tradition of detective shows: think *Karamchand*, *Byomkesh Bakshi*, *Reporter*, *Tehkikat*, *Raja aur Rancho*. But it took *C.I.D.*, producer-director B.P. Singh's Indian cop version of Sherlock Holmes, to break open the doors of mega success—captivating viewers over two decades (1998–2018). Arguably the longest running fiction show in India, each episode featured a new case solved by a team of police officers led by ACP Pradyuman. The talented Shivaji Satam went on to become synonymous with the character.

Antakshari/ Sa Re Ga Ma Pa/ Indian Idol

Talent shows, especially those featuring amateur singers, are a common motif among most general entertainment channels. Zee TV in 1993 was the first to create a homegrown format based on a popular game played in Indian households—*Antakshari*. The show was initially directed by Gajendra Singh and anchored by actors Annu Kapoor and Renuka Shahane and later by artistes like Sonu Nigam and Pallavi Joshi. The gameplay was simple, and it immediately became a hit with the viewers. Over the years, talent shows like *Sa Re Ga Ma Pa* (1995-) or its kids' version *L'il Champs* (2006-), *Indian Idol* (2004-) and *India's Got Talent* (2009-) have become a platform for talented singers from small towns and villages, and have given the world stars like Sunidhi Chauhan and Shreya Ghoshal.

